

LinkedTrust.us Case Study:

Earned Governance in Action



Learnings and Opportunities
from a Scrappy, Global Startup
Governed by its Team

Who are we?

- **What's Cookin' Inc** DBA LinkedTrust
- United States Public Benefit Corporation
- **Rolling SAFE** under Fairmint
- Global Team - All Share Equity
- Bylaws require that Governance is Earned and CEO is Elected
- **Verifiable Credentials & Web of Trust**
 - Skills and HR Tech
 - Impact Validation
 - Supply Chain and Commodity Markets
 - Decentralized Socials
 - Standards Development
- **Pilot projects and Competitive Bids**



Learning as We Grow

Our governance model **evolved organically** from tensions:

- **Fairness to global employees** working with little funding
- **Scrappy bootstrapping**
 - => no time for lengthy deliberation
 - => details change!
- Need for **trust**, **accountability** & **authentic power-sharing**

Problem:

Corporate Body Snatching

Dinosaur-brained traditional corporations not only fail to truly empower employees, but they are subject to **hostile takeover** that can subvert the original purpose

- Media & Journalism – ***Democracy Dies when, exactly?***
- Social Platforms – Users get no vote – is Tiktok next?
- Sold-out Startups – Remember **Flickr & Vine ?**

Employees with equity may get payouts, but it becomes impossible to build with purpose if a sellout is always looming on the horizon. Even without a takeover, pressures mount to abandon principles.



Our Working Model

"At LinkedTrust, we've built a battle-tested model of earned governance that works in the real world."

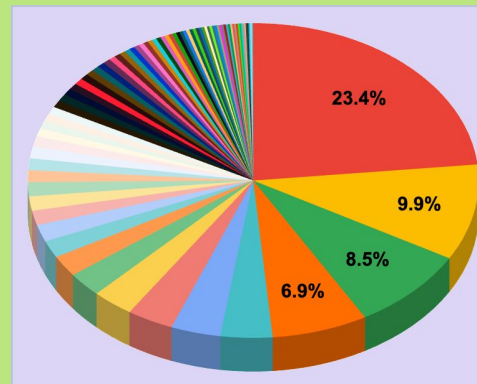
Transparency Not Permission

"With enough eyes, all bugs are shallow"

The OSS mantra applies to more than code. Visibility into resource allocation and decision making can be as powerful as voting, without the delay.

Earned Governance

Leaning on peer reviewed tasks, we allocate earned governance to those who are doing valuable work without extra overhead.



Democratic Leadership

CEO is elected by ranked choice work-weighted vote. Profits are spent by members submitting proposals to a rotating steering committee.

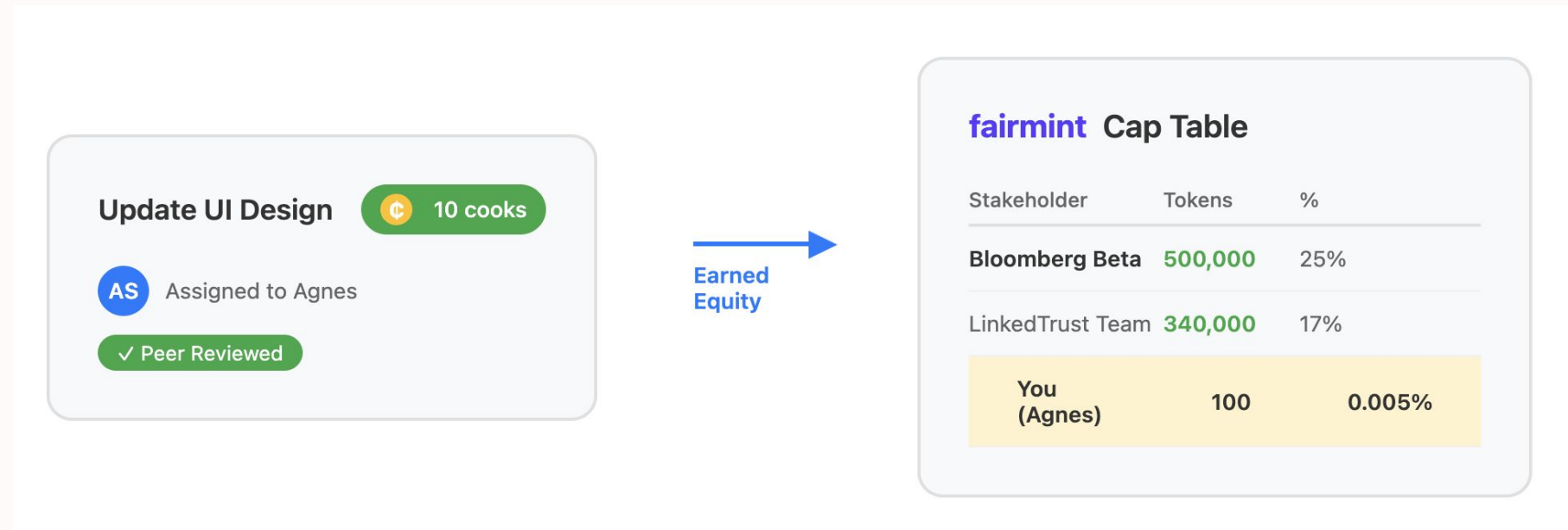


This lets us focus 95% of the time on the work in front of us, without distraction – but also with a higher level of trust in each other. Our global team has been incredibly dedicated to the shared purpose.

Technical Implementation

Task to Token

Building on familiar tools that development teams already use—task trackers, peer review processes, and story point estimation



Cultural Technology

Documenting best practices in a repo with AI helpers creates a living DNA of the agreed on processes.

Fairmint Equity Sharing - With Option Tokens

Leading tokenized Cap Table solution that combines investor equity with workers, and creates **liquidity without an exit**.

Legal Innovation & Protection

Legal Framework

Our model operates as a Public Benefit Corporation, proving that earned governance can thrive within established legal frameworks without complex restructuring.

Anti-Capture Design

"Because governance rights must be earned through contributions, our model prevents both external takeovers and internal power grabs that plague many democratic organizations."

Opportunity to Object
is baked into our bylaws

The Scale Opportunity

"We're ready to spread this DNA through an accelerator program that will launch multiple social enterprises."

Legal Templates

Public Benefit Corporation documents with contribution-based governance & Fairmint SAFE

Governance Playbook

Living repository of templates, processes and instructions for both humans and AI assistants.

Task-to-Token Toolkit

Integrate equity drops into the normal workflow with minimal overhead

Human Expert Guides

Seasoned consultants available worldwide to help spark new startups.



Interns: From Unpaid Labor to Startup Founders

1.5M

Engineering
Graduates
annually in India
alone

40+%

Unpaid
Internships
Even in US, 40%
are unpaid - many
more globally
(NACE 2021)

21%

Global
Engagement
Employee
engagement has
fallen markedly.
**Real ownership is
the answer**

Our accelerator transforms internships into founder pathways

through earned equity, and creates an 'startup index fund' to invest in
Stipends should always be included as funding allows.

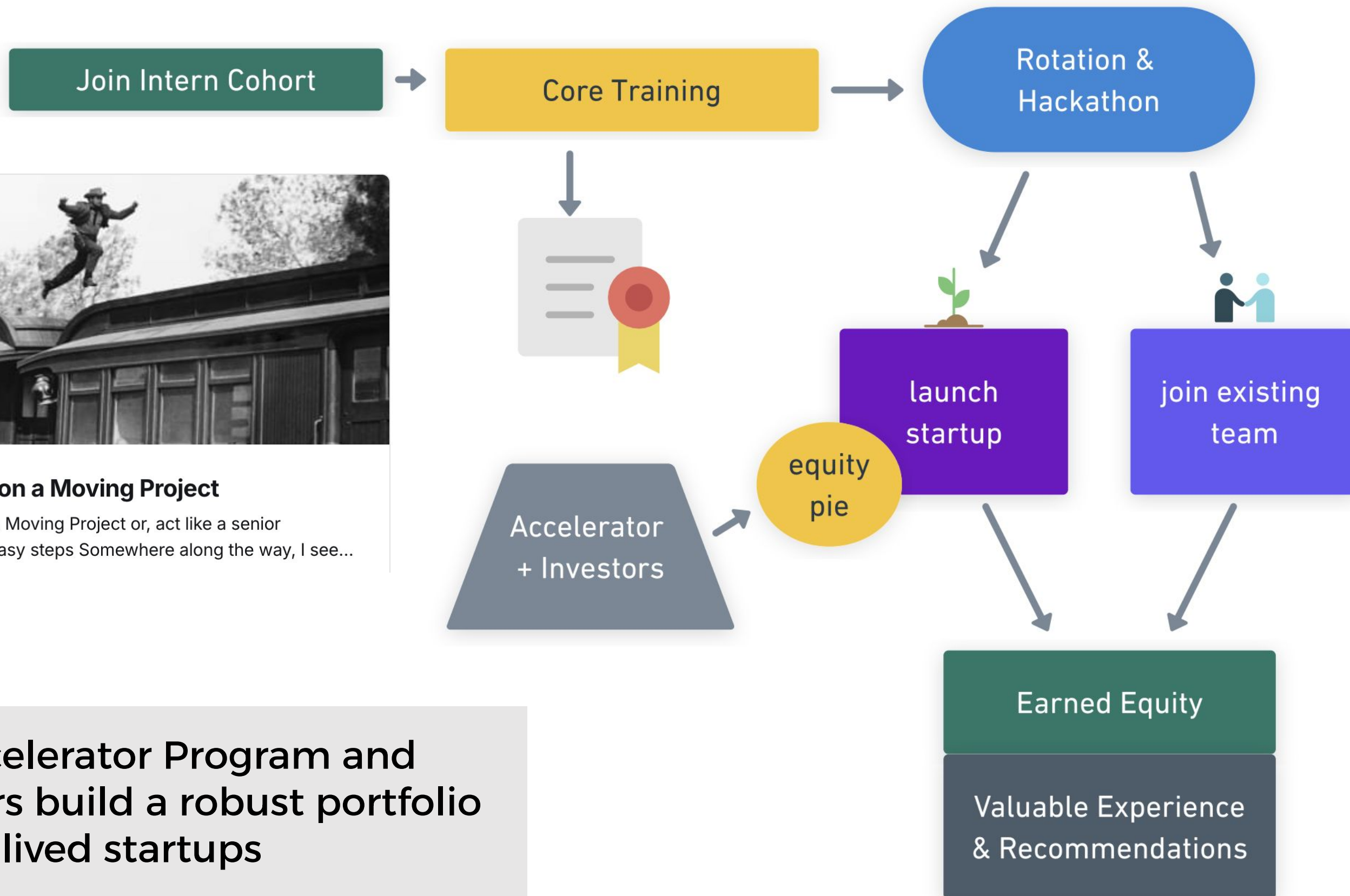




How to Jump on a Moving Project

How To Jump On A Moving Project or, act like a senior developer in nine easy steps Somewhere along the way, I see...

The Accelerator Program and Investors build a robust portfolio of long-lived startups



Why Now



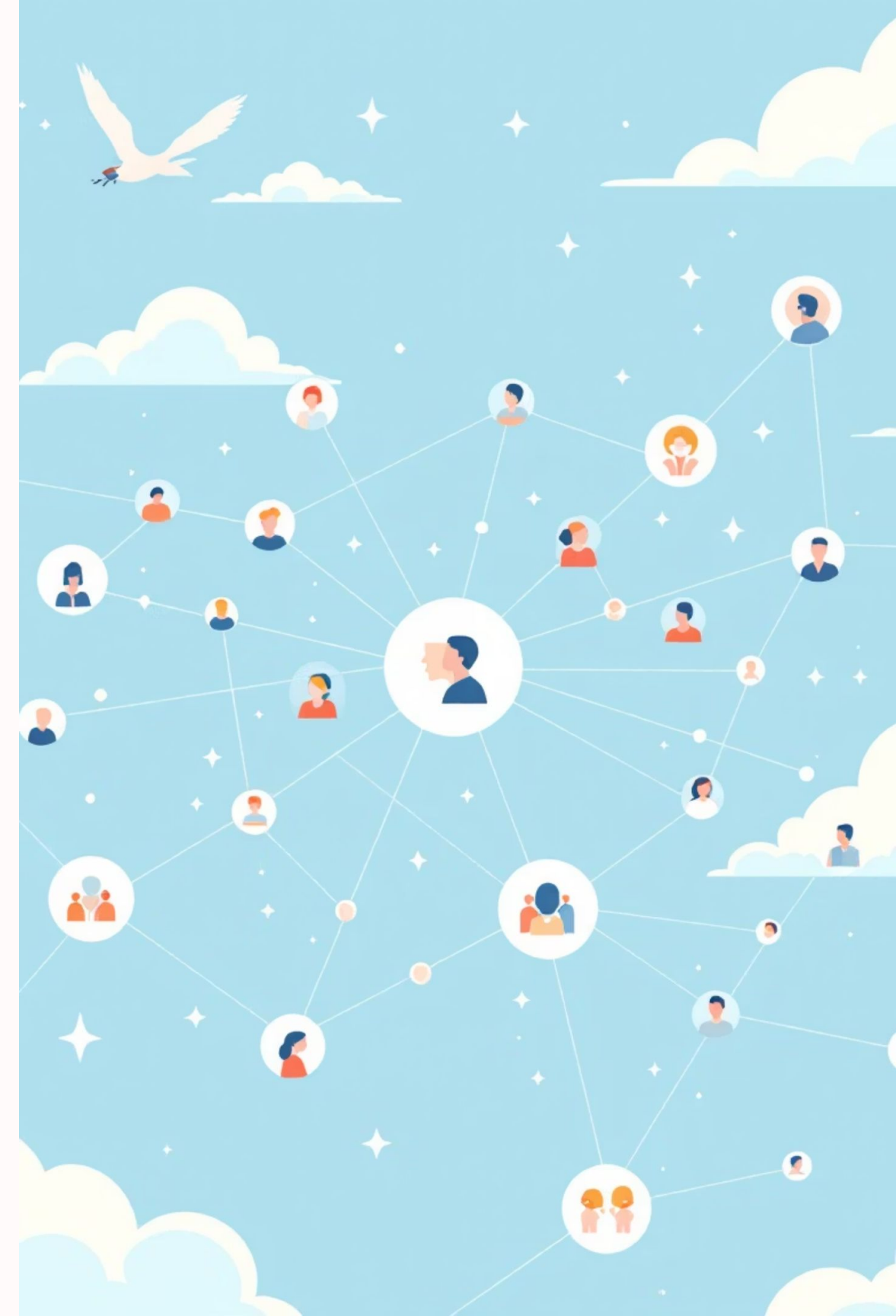
AI-Powered Scale

AI enables faster accelerators, and viral DNA spreading across organizations



Global Opportunity for "d" democracy

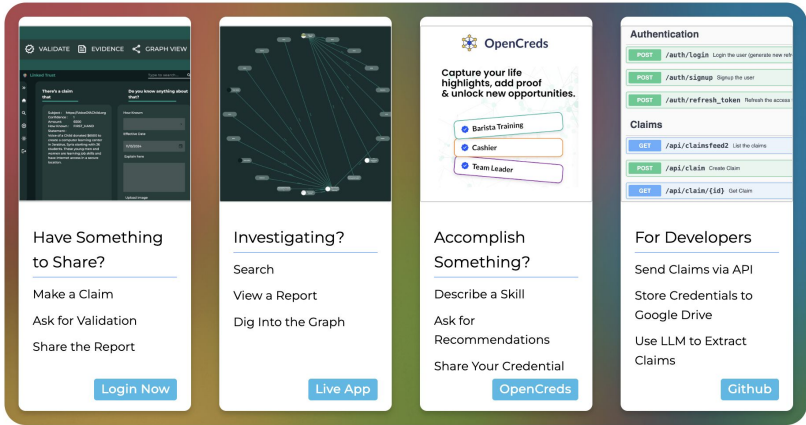
The need to exercise the muscle of self-governance has never been clearer. Small-d democracy can occur anywhere and strengthen the fabric and fairness of a rules-based order.



More about [LinkedTrust.us](#)

Verifiable Credentials in a Web of Trust

Try it Out.



Standards and Papers



Linked Claims

Specification Status: Draft



Composable Claims

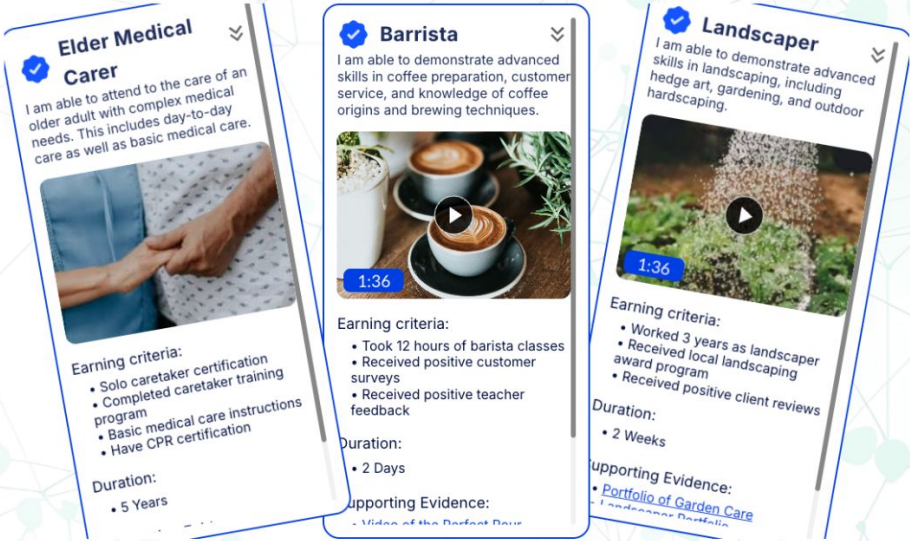
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Showcase the skills that define you.

Whether it's caring for your family, volunteering, a side hustle, or on-the-job learning, LinkedCreds helps you document, verify, and share your unique experiences.

Build your first skill



How it works - 3 simple steps

Questions?

Contact Us

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